



— BRAND DESIGN SYSTEM · V1.0

Groundwork.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Earthwork, not cyber. A visual system for laying the foundation — then keeping it standing.

AUGUST 2026 · GROUNDWORKSEC.COM

Three ways out of this file.

This is the canonical identity for Groundwork Security & Compliance. It matches the marketing site. Use it as a printed PDF, as vectors in Google Drive, or as the design system Claude Design extracts from.

Cover	01
How to use	02
Brand idea	03
The mark	04
Lockups	05
Clear space	06
Color	07
Pairings	08
Typography	09
Voice	10
Components	11
Applications	12
Claude Design & Drive	13
File index	14

Save these three

PDF — Use **Download PDF** in the toolbar. That file is the 14-page guide. Drop it into Google Drive as-is (Drive previews it). Same file for Claude Design.

Vectors — SVG mark, lockups, palette, and hill pattern in the kit. Drive previews SVG; Figma and Illustrator edit it.

Tokens — DESIGN.md + tokens.json so Claude does not invent a blue cybersecurity theme.

Lay the groundwork.

Groundwork is the missing layer for companies that need enterprise-grade proof without enterprise-grade headcount. The brand should feel like a foundation that is already load-bearing: warm, exact, Midwestern-honest. Not a SOC-in-a-box vendor. Not a hooded-hacker firm.

Earthy

Soil, clay, sand, canopy. The palette is dirt and fired earth. White and navy are off-brand.

Editorial

Fraunces headlines, short lines, kickers with a Clay rule. It should read like a well-set journal, not a SaaS dashboard.

Built

Stepped terraces. Courses of a foundation. We install programs that stay standing — the mark is that idea, compressed.

— WE ARE

Fractional CISO. Cloud groundwork.
Certification path. Operator who still ships.

— WE ARE NOT

A lock icon. A fear pitch. “AI-powered” as a personality. Generic fintech blue.

A foundation in 64 points.

The mark is a Soil tile with three stepped courses and a Sand mountain summit, its shadow face hatched like a pen drawing. It is an earthwork — not a shield and not a house. Do not redraw it.



- 01 Tile** Soil #1C2E26, 12px corners on a 64×64 square. This radius does not change.
- 02 Clay course** the ground line — #C4785A. Widest terrace, at the base.
- 03 Sage course** #A8B5A0. Steps in 4 units each side.
- 04 Terrace course** #5C7A62. The only place this green is required.
- 05 Summit** Sand #F4EFE6. Caps the work: apex at 32,14 with 45° slopes to a 20–44 base, matching the terrace course below. Keep the point sharp; do not round it.
- 06 Summit texture** a ridge hairline from below the apex and seven contour lines across the shadow face. These are cut out of the Sand shape, so the tile reads through them — never a second color, never a stroke. Nothing touches the outline, so the silhouette holds at any size.



Name sits beside the work.

Primary lockup is horizontal: mark, then Fraunces “Groundwork,” then Outfit small-caps “Security & Compliance.” Stacked lockup is for avatars, title pages, and square tiles.

Never rearrange the two lines or set the name in Outfit.



Groundwork
SECURITY & COMPLIANCE



Groundwork
SECURITY & COMPLIANCE



Groundwork
SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Groundwork
SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Give the courses room.

Clear space on every side is **25% of the mark's width** (16 units around a 64-unit tile).

Minimum size: **24px** on screen, **0.35 in** in print. Below that, use the full-color tile only — drop the wordmark. The summit texture is a large-format detail: below **32px**, and in any single-color or stitched reproduction, use the untextured summit. The favicon and the three mono cuts already ship that way.



Do not

- Recolor the terraces or swap Clay to the summit
- Thicken, redraw, or tint the summit hatching
- Drop a lock, shield, check, or cloud on the mark
- Stretch, rotate, outline, or add a drop shadow
- Place the open (tile-less) mark on photography
- Set “Groundwork” in a second typeface
- Use the Clay mono tile as the default avatar

Do

- Use full-color on Paper, Sand, or white
- Use full-color or Sand-mono on Soil
- Keep the tile when the mark sits on a photo
- Prefer the horizontal lockup in documents and decks

Named after ground.

Identity is Soil. Action is Clay. Canvas is Paper — never pure white, never navy. Clay is not a surface; it is a tool.

Soil #1C2E26 Identity / dark field	Canopy #24382F Dark raised card	Moss #4F6D58 Kicker / success	Terrace #5C7A62 Logo middle course
Sage #A8B5A0 On-dark secondary	Clay #C4785A Primary action	Clay Deep #9E5438 Hover / emphasis	Sand #F4EFE6 Warm band
Paper #FBF8F2 Page canvas	Ink #171C19 Text on light	Muted #5A635D Secondary text	Line rgba(28,46,38,.12) Hairline only

What sits on what.

IN BOUNDS

Ink on Paper

Body, headlines

Ink on Sand

Section bands

Sand on Soil

Dark sections

White on Clay

Buttons only

Sage on Soil

Meta on dark

Moss on Paper

Kickers

OUT OF BOUNDS

Role, not just hex

Claude Design will see Clay and try to paint with it. Stop it. Clay is one accent per composition. Soil is identity, not a paragraph color on Paper (too close, too heavy). Sage is not body text on Paper — contrast fails. No second accent. No blue, no gold, no neon.

TOKEN	HEX	ROLE
primary	#1C2E26	Soil — identity
secondary	#4F6D58	Moss — kicker
tertiary	#C4785A	Clay — action
neutral	#FBF8F2	Paper — canvas

Fraunces for the roof. Outfit for the rooms.

H1 · FRAUNCES 520

Lay the groundwork.

H2 · FRAUNCES
520

A first 90 days that leave something standing.

H3 · FRAUNCES
520

Cloud infrastructure that is already audit-shaped

LEDE · OUTFIT
400

Modern security and compliance for companies without a full-time CISO.

BODY · 17 / 1.65

Most growing companies hit the same wall: a customer sends a questionnaire — and there is nobody on staff whose job is to own it.

KICKER · 0.14EM

— FOR COMPANIES WITHOUT A SECURITY TEAM

ROLE	FAMILY	SIZE / TRACKING	NOTES
Display	Fraunces opsz 9–144	clamp 2.7–5.2rem / –0.035em	~11 characters on desktop
Body	Outfit	17px / –0.011em / 1.65	Muted for supporting copy
Button	Outfit 600	inherit / pill	Never Fraunces on buttons
Fallback	Iowan / Georgia · Avenir Next	—	Not Inter, not Roboto, not Geist

Straight answers. Built things.

Write like Jonathan talks: an auditor who still ships, and who owns a restaurant, so he feels every dollar a program costs. Short sentences. Concrete nouns. No theater.

Say

“Lay the groundwork. Get certified. Keep shipping.”

“A first 90 days that leave something standing.”

“Tell us what your buyers are asking for.”

“FedRAMP is a program, not a weekend.”

Don't say

“Next-gen AI-powered cybersecurity platform.”

“We leverage synergies to delight stakeholders.”

“In today's ever-evolving threat landscape...”

“Hackers are at the gate.”

Construction

install, baseline, path, standing, groundwork, course, handoff. Use them when they are true, not as decoration.

Honesty

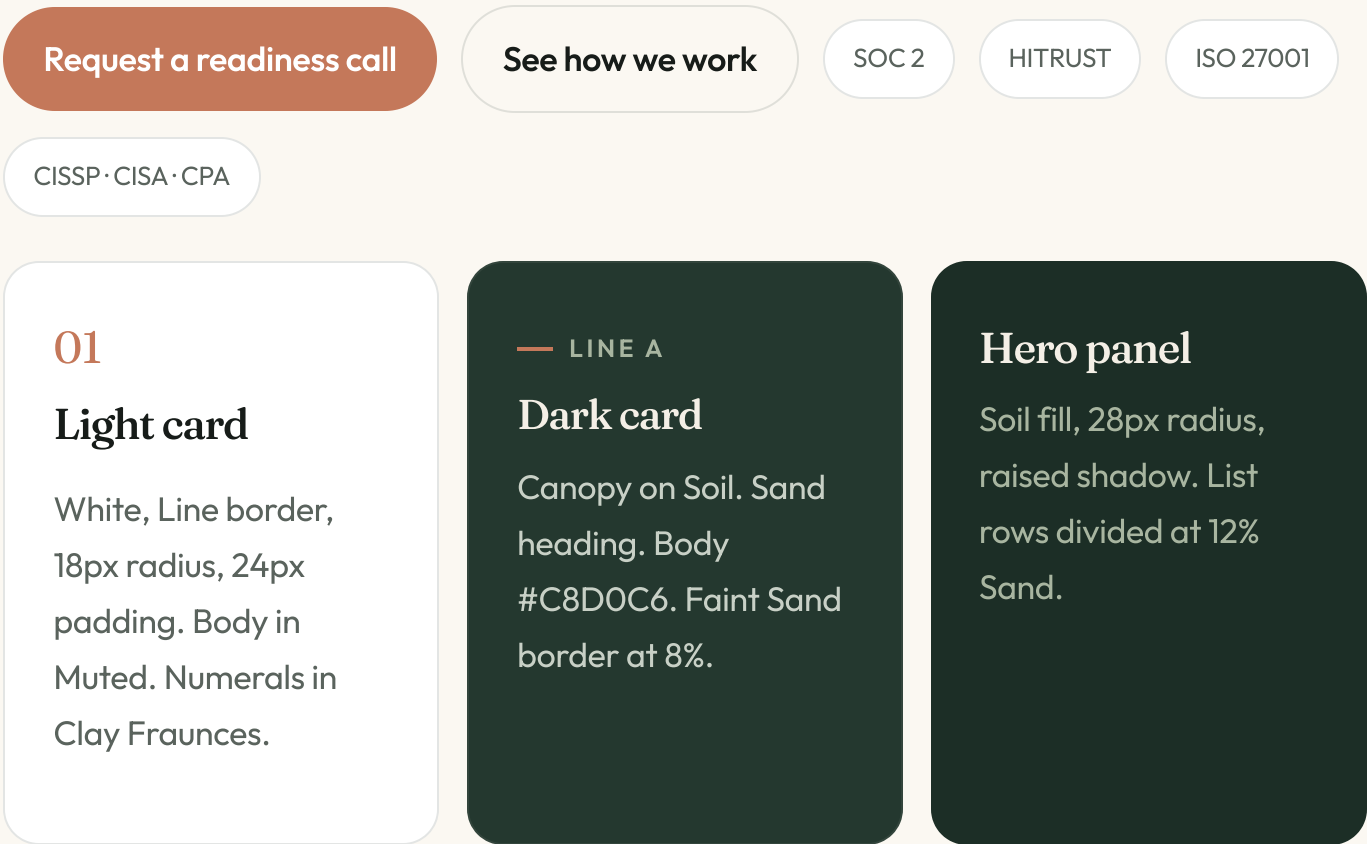
Scope what you would buy for yourself. If they are not ready, say so. Prefer a scoped proposal to a generic deck.

Proof

Framework names are chips, not poetry: SOC 2, HITRUST, ISO 27001, FedRAMP, HIPAA. Credentials sit next to the work, not above it.

The site is the UI kit.

Do not invent a second component language for decks and one-pagers. Borrow these shapes.



TOKEN	VALUE	WHERE
radius.sm / md / lg / full	12 / 18 / 28 / 999	inputs, cards, panels, pills
space.section	84px vertical	every marketing section
size.wrap	1180px	max content width
shadow.raised	0 24px 60px rgba(28,46,38,.12)	hero panel, portrait — not flat cards
nav	74px, Paper 86%	sticky, hairline, blur 16px

Same system, other surfaces.

— BUSINESS CARD



— TITLE SLIDE



One kit, two destinations.

Claude Design

At claude.com/product/design, create or remix the org design system. Upload this PDF, **DESIGN.md**, **tokens.json**, and **mark.svg**. Optionally paste the prompt in **CLAUDE-DESIGN.md**.

After extraction, generate a test landing page and an 8-slide deck. Reject output that is blue, uses Inter, or paints Clay as a full-bleed background.

Google Drive

Create a shared folder **Groundwork Brand**. Put the PDF at the root for anyone who needs to make a file. Put **logos/svg** in a Logos subfolder — Drive previews SVG; download for Figma/Illustrator/Canva.

New one-pagers and decks: start in Claude Design or Google Slides using Paper background, Fraunces titles, Clay buttons, then export PDF back into the same Drive folder.

UPLOAD	TOOL	RESULT
Groundwork-Brand-Guide.pdf	Claude Design, Drive	Visual source of truth
DESIGN.md	Claude, Cursor, Gemini	Token + rationale file
tokens/tokens.json	Claude Design, Figma Tokens	DTCG values
logos/svg/*.svg	Drive, Figma, print	Vectors
palette/groundwork-palette.svg	Drive, decks	Named swatches

This website is also a source: point Claude at the GitHub repo or groundworksec.com so it can read real layout, not only a palette.

What ships in the kit.

— VECTORS

logos/svg/mark.svg
logos/svg/mark-open.svg
logos/svg/mark-mono-soil.svg
logos/svg/mark-mono-sand.svg
logos/svg/mark-mono-clay.svg
logos/svg/lockup-horizontal-on-paper.svg
logos/svg/lockup-horizontal-on-soil.svg
logos/svg/lockup-stacked-on-paper.svg
logos/svg/lockup-stacked-on-soil.svg
logos/svg/wordmark-on-paper.svg
logos/svg/wordmark-on-soil.svg

— SYSTEM

DESIGN.md — agent-readable identity
tokens/tokens.json — DTCG
tokens/tokens.css — CSS variables
CLAUDE-DESIGN.md — upload checklist
palette/groundwork-palette.svg
pattern/hills.svg and hills-on-soil.svg
Groundwork-Brand-Guide.pdf
Groundwork-Brand-Kit.zip

— CONTACT

Jonathan Welzbacher · jon@groundworksec.com
groundworksec.com · St. Louis metro

Version 1.0 · August 2026

Drawn from the live marketing site. If the site and this book disagree later, update both. Do not fork a second palette.